

2.3.3 Hinduism

Religion and human relationships

Roles of men and women in the family	• Roles of men and women in a Hindu family • Roles of other family members according to the demands of varnashramadharma and the scriptures
Marriage and marriage ceremonies	• Marriage ceremonies in India and the UK • The symbolism and the meaning of the various features of the ceremonies • The ways in which the ceremonies reflect and emphasise Hindu teaching about marriage • Responses to civil partnerships
Divorce	• Beliefs about the ethics of divorce in India and the UK • Beliefs about the ethics of re-marriage in India and the UK

Sexual relationships and contraception

- Attitudes towards sexual relationships as they relate to varnashramadharma and kama as a valid life goal during the grihastha ashrama
- Teachings about celibacy and renunciation including the tapas and the teachings of M.K. Gandhi:
- Beliefs about contraception, including the idea of ahimsa
- Social concerns about contraception

Religion and medical ethics

Attitudes to abortion

- Different attitudes towards abortion, including the ideas of the atman and karma
- Reasons for different attitudes

Attitudes to fertility treatment

- Responses to issues raised by fertility treatment and cloning, including the ideas of the atman and karma

Attitudes to euthanasia and suicide

- Different attitudes towards euthanasia
- Different attitudes towards suicide
- Reasons for different attitudes
- The idea of ahimsa and teachings about samsara in relation to euthanasia and suicide

Using animals in medical research

- Beliefs about the use of animals in medical research
- The idea of ahimsa and teachings about samsara in relation to research

Religion, poverty and wealth

Religious views of wealth and the causes of hunger, poverty and disease

- Wealth
- Causes of hunger, poverty and disease
- Poverty and disease related to pollution and environmental conditions
- Responses to the needs of the starving, the poor and the sick

Concern for others

- Teachings about dana and samsara in relation to caring for others
- Understandings of 'charity', including atathi
- Prashad
- Different ways charity is put into practice

The uses of money

- Teachings about the use of money (e.g. gambling, lending)
 - Giving to charity
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Moral and immoral occupations

- Concept of moral and immoral
 - Teachings about moral and immoral occupations, including dharma and varnashramadharma and the concept of ahimsa
 - Impact of teachings on believers
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